

02b — Design Blueprint & Build Audit — Underground Colosseum (v3)

undergroundcolosseum.com | hero site | affiliate | fills doc 02 §7 “detailed design” gap

Inherits: 00-PLATFORM-ARCHITECTURE, 01-TEMPLATE-LIBRARY, 02-PRD/TRD-UNDERGROUND-COLOSSEUM · Design source: 05-PRD/TRD-STREET-FOOD-ROME (live reference build)

Status: v3 — supersedes v2 after a correction pass: static-rendering added for all 13 real pages, GA4/GSC/Bing wiring built (infra-ready, pending real credentials), and the tour-data-source finding corrected after verifying it against Street Food Rome’s actual pattern; re-audited directly against the live repository (italy-tours-platform), 2026-09-12

0. What this document is

Doc 02 (“02 — PRD/TRD: Underground Colosseum”) specifies this property’s content, structure and keyword map, but defers its visual design: “§7 Design intent” says only “ships a distinct bespoke design — detailed design to follow in the design phase.” This document is that design phase, written after inspecting the actual project repository (italy-tours-platform) rather than proposing something new from scratch — Underground Colosseum’s homepage, all 5 money pages, all 6 support pages, About and Contact are already built. What follows documents the design system actually shipped, verifies it against doc 02 and doc 00’s requirements, and lists exactly what stands between the current build and “the absolute best” version of it.

The core design decision already made in code (see the header comment in `UndergroundColosseumHome.tsx`): rather than an original T1 Monument palette, Underground Colosseum’s “bespoke” design deliberately reuses **Street Food Rome’s (doc 05) exact color, type and component language** — the platform’s first, fully-built, proven reference implementation — so every property reads as the same trustworthy network rather than a patchwork of styles. That is the instruction this document treats as settled; the sections below capture what it produced and where to polish it.

What was new in v2: v1’s punch list had been actioned — Product/Offer schema, the missing sitemap entries, per-page tour relevance, WebSite/Organization JSON-LD, and three new content modules (a comparison table, an at-a-glance summary box, and a historical-facts strip).

What’s new in v3: this pass was a correction and close-out pass, not new content. Three things changed: (1) `generateStaticParams` now pre-renders all 13 real Underground Colosseum pages, closing v2’s one remaining Low finding that touched code rather than content; (2) GA4 + Search Console + Bing verification wiring now exists platform-wide (`lib/analytics.ts`) — infrastructure-ready, but still inert until real credentials are set, since this document does not fabricate account IDs; (3) the “tour collection is hardcoded” item from v1/v2 is corrected here, not resolved — it was never actually a gap (see §6). See §3 for the updated checklist, §5 for v1’s fixes, §6 for what closed and what was corrected this pass, and §7 for what’s still genuinely open.

1. Design system (copied from Street Food Rome, doc 05)

1.1 Color tokens

Every hex value below is read directly out of the shipped components (Header.tsx, Hero.tsx, TourCard.tsx, Footer.tsx and their Underground Colosseum equivalents) — not the unused CSS-variable palette in `globals.css` (see §7, still open).

	Token	Hex	Usage
	Accent / primary CTA	#ff0022	Buttons, links, active nav, price labels' arrow, category-chip text. Hover state #e0001d.

	Ink	#1a1a1a	Headlines, primary body text, nav wordmark.
	Muted text	#5c6166	Secondary copy, descriptions, card metadata.
	Faint text	#9aa0a5	Placeholders, timestamps, breadcrumb separators, icons at rest.
	Border	#e8ebed	Card borders, dividers, input borders, header/footer rules.
	Section tint	#f9fafa	Alternating section backgrounds (never the dominant page color).
	Media fill	#f4f4f4	Image placeholder / loading background behind every photo.
	Gold (secondary accent)	#b8862e	Price-band badges, urgency notes, rating/clock icons — used sparingly, never as a CTA color.
	Success green	#4c8c4a	Trust-point checkmarks (“Own arena-floor photography”, etc.).

1.2 Typography

Role	Font	Notes
Body, nav, buttons, most headings	Public Sans	Loaded as <code>--font-public-sans</code> ; extrabold weight on H1/H2 across home, money and support pages.
FAQ question text only (currently)	Fraunces (<code>font-display</code>)	Applied narrowly to <code><summary></code> elements. The shared platform’s InnerHero component uses this serif for page H1s too, but Underground Colosseum’s own H1s use Public Sans extrabold instead — a deliberate divergence, not flagged as an open finding.
Numerals	<code>tabular-nums</code> utility	Available platform-wide; not currently applied to price figures on Underground Colosseum cards — minor polish opportunity.

1.3 Layout, spacing & components

Element	Spec
Page containers	1440px (header/footer) · 1200px (section content) · 896px (hero/search) · 760px (reading column: body copy, FAQ)
Gutters	px-6 mobile · px-14 (≈56px) desktop
Radii	6px buttons/inputs · 10px brand mark · 16px (rounded-2xl) cards · full pills/avatars
Card pattern	aspect-[4/3] image · rounded-2xl · 1px #e8ebed border · hover: lift 4px + soft shadow (0 16px 32px rgba(26,26,26,.08))
Carousels	Horizontal scroll-snap track + looping prev/next circular arrow buttons (shared <code>useCardCarousel</code> hook) — identical pattern on both properties
Header	Sticky, 65px, white, 1px bottom border, brand mark + wordmark, primary nav, CTA button
Footer	Multi-column (Company/Explore/Learn/Network/Contact), 1px top border, #f9fafa tint, copyright + affiliate-disclosure line

Element	Spec
Motion	200–500ms ease color/transform transitions; image scale-105 on card hover; chevron rotate-180 on open menus/accordions

1.4 New shared components (added this pass)

Four additions to `UCShared.tsx`, built to the same visual language as §1.1–1.3 rather than as one-off styling — each reuses the existing `card/border/radius` tokens above.

Component	Where used	Purpose
TourComparisonTable	Homepage + all 5 money pages	Full row-by-row spec table (tour, partner, duration, arena-floor inclusion, price, link) alongside the existing card grid — a scanning mode the card-only layout didn't serve.
QuickFactsStrip	Homepage (“Colosseum by the Numbers”)	5-stat responsive grid of verifiable historical facts (built 80 AD, 50,000+ capacity, 80 entrances, hypogeum construction dates, 2010 reopening) — editorial depth without inventing business/traffic metrics this independent site has no way to claim.
AtAGlanceBox	All 5 money pages, hero column	Scannable price/group-size/booking-window summary; every value restates something already stated in that page's own body copy, so nothing new is asserted, only surfaced earlier.
PhotoGallery	<code>/arena-floor-walkthrough-photos</code>	4-image grid for the one support page whose premise is first-hand photography (doc 01's T1 “photo-gallery” block), previously a single hero image.

Tour ordering: money pages no longer import the raw `FEATURED_TOURS` array directly. A new `getFeaturedToursForPage(href)` helper in `lib/underground-colosseum.ts` stable-sorts the 8 tours by a per-page relevance map (e.g. the Kids page ranks the family-paced tour first) before both the comparison table and the card grid render — the one Medium finding from v1 §5 that touched data logic rather than markup.

2. Page-by-page blueprint (as built)

Verified directly against the live component tree (`UndergroundColosseumHome.tsx`, `MoneyPageTemplate.tsx`, `SupportPageTemplate.tsx`, `UCAboutPage.tsx`, `UCContactPage.tsx`) and its content source (`underground-colosseum-content.ts`).

Home (`/underground-colosseum`)

Section	Content
Hero	Full-bleed value prop, two CTAs (Compare Underground Tours / Is it worth it?), trust checkmarks, 4:3 Colosseum photo
Quick-jump chips	7-item horizontal scroller linking to every money + support anchor/page
“Colosseum by the Numbers” (new)	QuickFactsStrip — 5-stat grid of verified historical facts, placed ahead of the money pages carousel
Money pages carousel	5 cards, one per money page, badge + keyword pill + CTA
Featured tours carousel	8 live-style cards across GetYourGuide/Viator/Tiqets, price-from + partner badge

Section	Content
"Compare All 8 Tours" (new)	TourComparisonTable — full spec table for every featured tour, placed directly after the carousel
"Know before you go"	3 teaser cards: Worth-it verdict, Arena floor photos, Opening-hours mini-table
Plan Your Visit grid	6 support-page cards (2-col), thumbnail + keyword pill
FAQ	4 questions, accordion, FAQPage JSON-LD
Author box + Footer	Named author (Luca Moretti) + 5-column footer incl. Our Network cross-links

5 money pages — MoneyPageTemplate (**breadcrumb**, **hero**, **intro**, **AtAGlanceBox**, **body sections**, **verdict box**, **TourComparisonTable** + **4-card grid** ordered by getFeaturedToursForPage, **FAQ**, **author box**)

Path	Primary keyword	Badge
/underground-arena-floor-tour	colosseum underground tour	Most Popular
/skip-the-line-colosseum-tickets	skip the line colosseum	Fastest Entry
/private-vs-group-colosseum-tour	private colosseum tour	—
/colosseum-with-kids-family-guide	colosseum with kids	Family Friendly
/best-colosseum-tour-by-visitor-type	best colosseum tour	—

6 support pages — SupportPageTemplate (**breadcrumb**, **hero**, **body sections**, **related-money CTA box**, **FAQ**, **author box**)

Path	Primary keyword
/how-underground-access-really-works	colosseum underground access
/opening-hours-beating-the-crowds	colosseum opening hours
/arena-floor-walkthrough-photos	colosseum arena floor
/getting-there-metro-meeting-points	how to get to colosseum
/colosseum-forum-palatine-itinerary	colosseum forum palatine itinerary
/is-the-underground-worth-it	is colosseum underground worth it

New: /arena-floor-walkthrough-photos now renders a 4-image PhotoGallery after its body copy — the one support page whose whole premise is photography no longer stops at a single hero image.

About & Contact — author credibility + non-affiliation statement; mailto contact + full affiliate-disclosure block (GetYourGuide / Viator / Tiqets named explicitly). No submission form, by design: there is no backend to receive one, so a dead form was deliberately avoided in favor of an honest mailto link.

3. Doc 02 build checklist — verified against the live repo

DONE = verified in the codebase **PARTIAL** = partially true, see note **GAP** = not found / not started

- **[DONE]** Site record / registry entry — NETWORK_SITES in lib/tours.ts (number 02, slug underground-colosseum)
 - **[DONE]** Home + 5 money pages + 6 support pages drafted & “published” (statically reachable, real content, no lorem ipsum)
 - **[DONE]** Author entity present (Luca Moretti, bio, credentials) — *real photo shoot still outstanding, tracked in-code as a known TODO*
 - **[DONE] Tour data modeling (corrected)** — FEATURED TOURS is deliberately a static array of curated third-party affiliate listings, not a gap against Street Food Rome’s Firestore-backed first-party TourDoc pattern; the two are different content types by design (see §6)
 - **[DONE]** Schema validated: BreadcrumbList ✓, FAQPage ✓, TouristAttraction ✓, Product/Offer ✓ — all four schema types doc 02 §1 requires are emitted on every money page
 - **[DONE]** Keyword-map collision check — manually verified: all 11 money+support primary keywords are unique, no overlap
 - **[DONE]** Sitemap coverage — all 13 real Underground Colosseum pages listed in sitemap.ts at their correct priority tiers, no longer folded into the placeholder-root entry shared with the 12 unbuilt siblings
 - **[DONE] Static rendering (new)** — generateStaticParams added to the catch-all route; all 13 real pages now pre-render at build time like the rest of the platform
 - **[GAP]** Redirect domains assigned / template micro-sites built (privatecolosseum.com, colosseumprivate.com, colosseumkids.com, .it/tours/.info) — not started; out of scope for this hero-only audit
 - **[PARTIAL] GA4 + GSC + Bing verification (new)** — wiring now exists platform-wide (lib/analytics.ts, read into layout.tsx’s metadata and GA4 script tag); still inert until real measurement/verification IDs are set in the deployment’s env vars — that step needs the account owner, not code
 - **[PARTIAL]** Governance checks green — cross-network linking is present in UCHeader/UCFooter, which is a documented, deliberate exception to doc 00/01’s “no owned-site links” rule (see §8), not an oversight
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4. What’s already excellent

- Content is genuinely specific, not templated filler: real Colosseum hours by season, passport requirements, hypogeum mechanics, age minimums for underground access, combo-ticket rules — the kind of detail that only comes from someone who actually researched (or walked) the routes, matching the PRD’s “first-hand detail in first 100 words” requirement.
 - Visual system is fully consistent across all 13 pages — one shared header/footer/author-box/FAQ/carousel component set (UCShared.tsx), not 13 bespoke one-off layouts silently drifting apart.
 - Every money and support page carries its own unique H1, meta title, meta description and FAQ block — doc 02’s “no two pages share a primary keyword” rule holds up under inspection.
 - robots.ts allows crawling of the whole site (only /account and /search are disallowed) — nothing is accidentally blocking these 13 pages from being indexed.
 - The cross-network-linking exception is *documented in code as a deliberate, explicit decision*, not a silent governance violation — easy to audit and easy to reverse later if the network isolation rule is reinstated.
 - This pass’s new content (quick facts, at-a-glance boxes, the comparison table) adds density without inventing anything: every figure either restates copy the page already had, or is a verifiable historical fact about the Colosseum itself — no fabricated visitor counts or invented testimonials, consistent with the rest of the site’s honesty-first posture.
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5. v1 findings, resolved

Both Critical items and two of the four Medium/Low items from the v1 blueprint have shipped this pass.

[RESOLVED — WAS CRITICAL] Product/Offer schema is missing on every money page

Fixed: MoneyPageTemplate now emits one Product/Offer JSON-LD node per compared tour (partner as brand, priceFrom as offers.price, EUR, InStock availability), alongside the existing BreadcrumbList, FAQPage and TouristAttraction blocks. All four schema types doc 02 §1 requires are now present.

[RESOLVED — WAS CRITICAL] Sitemap.ts does not list any of the 13 real Underground Colosseum pages

Fixed: sitemap.ts now excludes underground-colosseum from the shared low-priority NETWORK_SITES placeholder list and instead lists its own 13 real pages (home, 5 money, 6 support, about, contact) at their correct priority tiers.

[RESOLVED — WAS MEDIUM] All 5 money pages show the identical 8 featured-tour cards, in the identical order

Fixed: a new getFeaturedToursForPage(href) helper stable-sorts the 8 tours by a per-page relevance map before rendering, so each money page now leads with the tours most relevant to its own topic.

[RESOLVED — WAS MEDIUM] No WebSite/Organization JSON-LD on the Underground Colosseum homepage

Fixed: UndergroundColosseumHome.tsx now emits WebSite and Organization JSON-LD alongside its existing FAQPage and ItemList blocks, mirroring the pattern already shipped on the Street Food Rome homepage.

6. v2 findings — closed or corrected this pass

The three items this pass was asked to address: static rendering, analytics wiring, and the tour-data-source question.

[RESOLVED — WAS LOW] Money/support sub-pages have no generateStaticParams

Fixed: app/[slug]/[...rest]/page.tsx now exports generateStaticParams, building the 13 real Underground Colosseum sub-paths (5 money, 6 support, about, contact) from the same static registries (MONEY_PAGES, SUPPORT_PAGES, ARENA_FLOOR_PAGE, WORTH_IT_PAGE) already used elsewhere, matching the pattern the root [slug] page and /tours/[slug] already followed. Every other sub-path this catch-all route handles (the 12 unbuilt sibling properties, /go/:slug) is untouched — dynamicParams defaults to true, so nothing not listed here regresses.

[INFRA-READY — PENDING CREDENTIALS] GA4 + GSC + Bing verification wired to this property specifically

Built, not fully closed: a new lib/analytics.ts reads NEXT_PUBLIC_GA_MEASUREMENT_ID, GOOGLE_SITE_VERIFICATION and BING_SITE_VERIFICATION from env vars (documented in infra/env/.env.example, same pattern as the existing Firebase/revalidate secrets); layout.tsx now renders the GA4 gtag script and sets metadata.verification from them. All three are undefined until real values are set — this document does not invent a measurement ID or a verification token, since a fake one would either report to no real property or fail Google/Bing's ownership check outright. **Action needed from the account owner, not engineering:** create/locate the real GA4 property, Search Console and Bing Webmaster verification codes and set the three env vars in Vercel — at that point this activates with no further code change. One platform-wide ID today (single Next.js app serving all 13 properties); split into a per-site lookup later if each hero site needs its own GA4 property.

[CORRECTED — WAS OPEN] Tour collection is “hardcoded, not pulled from a live data source”

This was carried in v1/v2 as an open gap by analogy to Street Food Rome. Re-checked directly against `lib/firestore.ts` this pass: Street Food Rome’s tours Firestore collection holds first-party tour content the site itself authors and owns (title, first-hand notes, pricing it sets). `FEATURED_TOURS` is a different kind of data entirely — curated listings of *other companies’* products (GetYourGuide/Viator/Tickets), where the price and availability belong to those partners, not this site. Syncing that from an unreviewed live feed would risk showing a stale or wrong price under an affiliate-disclosure page, which is the one place accuracy matters most. **Correction, not a fix:** the finding is removed from the open list; the array is annotated in-code (see the new comment above `FEATURED_TOURS`) so the next person doesn’t re-flag it as the same gap. Revisit only if/when Underground Colosseum gets its own live affiliate-feed integration — a partner-API decision, not a refactor to make speculatively.

7. Still open

Three untouched carry-forwards, plus one item this pass built the plumbing for but couldn’t finish alone.

[OPEN — NEEDS THE ACCOUNT OWNER] Real GA4/GSC/Bing credentials not yet set

The wiring described in §6 is live in code and waiting; the only remaining step is pasting three real values (a GA4 measurement ID, a Search Console verification code, a Bing Webmaster verification code) into Vercel’s project env vars. That’s a business/account step — creating or locating those properties in the user’s own Google/Bing accounts — not something this document can complete on its own.

[HIGH] The design-token system exists but nothing uses it

`tailwind.config.ts` defines `paper / ink / accent / gold / line` as CSS-variable-backed Tailwind colors specifically so each of the 13+ properties can theme via variables instead of forking components (doc 00’s whole multi-tenant premise). In practice, every component on both Street Food Rome and Underground Colosseum hardcodes raw hex (`#ff0022`, `#1a1a1a`, etc.) instead of the accent/ink tokens. The token file’s own values (a wine-red `#7a2331` accent) don’t even match what shipped (`#ff0022`) — the system was designed, then bypassed. Left as-is, every one of the remaining 11 hero builds will keep copy-pasting hex strings by hand rather than swapping one token file. Worth reconciling before property #3 starts.

[LOW] Scroll behavior is inconsistent between the two properties

Street Food Rome’s Header hides on scroll-down and reappears on scroll-up (more content real estate while reading). `UHeader` is sticky but always visible. Not wrong, but since the stated goal is “the two properties read as the same platform,” this is a small, noticeable behavioral seam worth a decision either way rather than an accident.

[OPEN] Real author photography is still outstanding

Already tracked honestly in-code (an initials avatar stands in for Luca Moretti rather than a stock photo pretending to be one) — not a new finding, just carried forward from doc 02’s own build checklist as still open.

8. Governance exception on record

Doc 00 §8 (M10) states: “No cross-links between owned sites — lint rule scans internal link graph, fails build on `hero↔hero` or `hero↔redirect` owned-domain links.” Underground Colosseum’s header (“Our Network” dropdown) and footer (“Our Network” column) both link to the other 12 sibling properties. The in-code comment on `SIBLING_SITES` confirms this was added “at the user’s explicit direction, overriding the blueprint’s default ‘no sibling links’ isolation rule for this site.” This document records that exception formally so it reads as a decision, not a governance-check failure the next time doc 00’s dup-content/no-cross-link lint runs against this property.

9. Rollout recommendation

Street Food Rome remains `ACTIVE_NETWORK_SLUG` (the platform's default/root site); Underground Colosseum is reachable today only at `/underground-colosseum`, not at the root domain. With both v1 Critical items closed, the page noticeably richer (comparison table, at-a-glance box, facts strip, gallery), all 13 real pages statically pre-rendered, and the tour-data-source question resolved as a non-issue, only one action item requires anyone outside this codebase: set the three analytics env vars once real GA4/GSC/Bing credentials exist (§6). Beyond that, the remaining sequence is: (1) reconcile the design-token system so property #3 onward doesn't repeat the hardcoded-hex pattern; (2) only then decide the timing of promoting Underground Colosseum toward its own domain/active status — that switch changes root-path routing in `middleware.ts` and is worth doing deliberately, not as a side effect of a content fix.

Sign-off checklist for this document

- **[DONE]** Product/Offer JSON-LD added to `MoneyPageTemplate`
- **[DONE]** Underground Colosseum's 13 real pages added to `sitemap.ts` at appropriate priority tiers
- **[DONE]** `FEATURED TOURS` varied/reordered per money page (`getFeaturedToursForPage`)
- **[DONE]** `WebSite/Organization` JSON-LD added to `UndergroundColosseumHome`
- **[DONE]** Comparison table, at-a-glance box and facts strip shipped
- **[DONE]** `generateStaticParams` added for the 13 Underground Colosseum sub-paths
- **[DONE]** GA4/GSC/Bing wiring built and documented (`lib/analytics.ts`, `.env.example`)
- **[DONE]** Tour-data-source finding corrected in this document and annotated in-code
- **[PARTIAL]** Real GA4/GSC/Bing credentials set in Vercel env vars — needs the account owner, tracked as open in §7
- **[GAP]** Design tokens reconciled (`tailwind.config.ts` values updated to match shipped hex, or components migrated to consume the tokens)
- **[GAP]** Scroll-hide header behavior decided (adopt or explicitly reject) for parity with Street Food Rome
- **[GAP]** Real author photography scheduled